

**ENGLISH****Section-A [Reading Comprehension (Seen)]****Answer either from Group-A or from Group-B****Group-A [New Syllabus]**

**1. Read the following paragraphs and answer the questions that follow :**

There came in our town some years ago a showman owning an institution called the Gaiety Land. Overnight our Gymkhana Grounds had crowds pouring into the show from all over the district. Gaiety Land provided us with all sorts of fun and games and slide shows. For a couple of annas in each booth we could watch anything from performing parrots to crack motorcyclists looping loop in the Dome of Death ; moreover there were lotteries and shooting galleries.

There was a particular corner of the show which was in great favour. Here one stood a chance of winning a variety of articles—pincushions, sewing machines, cameras or even a road engine. On one evening they drew ticket number 1005, which belonged to me and they declared that I had become the owner of the road engine—

It was not the sort of prize one could carry home at short notice. However, the showman agreed to keep the engine on the Gymkhana Grounds till the end of their season, and then I would have to make my own arrangements to take it out.

**(a) Complete each of the following sentences with information from the text above:** **2×4=8**

(i) An institution called the Gaiety Land was owned

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(ii) The Gaiety Land offered the visitors

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(iii) In each booth the visitors could watch

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(iv) A particular corner of the show was in great favour because

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**(b) Answer the following questions in a sentence or two : 2×2=4**

(i) How did the narrator become the owner of a road engine?

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(ii) What problem did the narrator face after he had won the prize?

2. Read the first *three* stanzas of the poem 'Ring Out, Wild Bells' given below and answer the questions that follow :

Ring out, wild bells, to the wild sky,

The flying cloud, the frosty light :

The year is dying in the night ;

Ring out, wild bells, and let him die.

Ring out the old, ring in the new,

Ring, happy bells, across the snow :

The year is going, let him go ;

Ring out the false, ring in the true.

Ring out the grief that saps the mind,

For those that here we see no more ;

Ring out the feud of rich and poor,

Ring in redress to all mankind.

(a) Answer the following questions :  $2 \times 2 = 4$

(i) Why is the sky 'wild'?

(ii) Give the meaning of the phrase 'redress to all mankind'.

(b) Each of the statements below is either 'True' or 'False'. Write 'T' for 'True' and 'F' for 'False' in the boxes on the right-hand side. Also pick out the relevant line(s) or phrase from the poem in support of your answer:  $2 \times 2 = 4$

(i) The poet wishes the year to continue.

Supporting line(s) / phrase : \_\_\_\_\_

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(ii) The poet feels sad for those who are no more.

Supporting line(s) / phrase : \_\_\_\_\_

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### [Reading Comprehension (Unseen)]

3. Read the following text and answer the questions that follow :

Kolkata....Basanta Singha Roy and Debabrata Biswas of the Mountaineers' Association of Krishnanagar (MAK) in West Bengal's Nadia district set foot on the peak of Mt Everest at 7.45 a.m. on Monday, 17 May, 2010.

"The team had intended to climb Everest from the Tibetan side through the North Col\* and the Northeast ridge. But they had trouble



getting the necessary permissions from the Chinese Government.” Alok Ray, son of Ashok Ray who was one of the members of the expedition, thus informed The Hindu over telephone from Krishnanagar.

The seven-member expedition, including five members of MAK and two locals, Pasang Sherpa and Pemba Sherpa, had started off on April 4 to scale the peak from the Nepalese side of the mountain. They crossed the treacherous Khumbu Icefall on May 12. According to the schedule, they were to have reached the peak on Sunday morning but bad weather caused a delay.

“This is a momentous achievement and when the climbers return the State Government shall felicitate them,” said West Bengal’s Sports Minister, Kanti Ganguly.

Members of the Association have earlier successfully climbed several peaks of the Himalayan range. The decision to climb Everest was to commemorate the Association’s silver jubilee year.

The State Government has awarded Rs 5 lakh to the Association to encourage its activities.

(Based on the report published in The Hindu, Tuesday, 18 May, 2010 )

\* Col—a low point between two higher points in a mountain range.

**A. Fill in the following chart with information from the passage above:** **1×6 = 6**

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| (i) The names of the persons who first set foot on Mount Everest from West Bengal : |  |
| (ii) Name of the Association mentioned here :                                       |  |
| (iii) Number of members in the expedition:                                          |  |
| (iv) Name of the Icefall referred to :                                              |  |
| (v) Reason for the decision made by MAK to climb Mount Everest:                     |  |
| (vi) Source of the text :                                                           |  |



**B. Complete the following sentences with information from the given text :**  $2 \times 4 = 8$

(a) The team could not climb Everest from the Tibetan side because \_\_\_\_\_

(b) The local persons from the hill in the expedition were \_\_\_\_\_

(c) The expedition began to climb the peak from \_\_\_\_\_

(d) The West Bengal Sports Minister decides to felicitate the members of the expedition because \_\_\_\_\_

**C. Answer the questions in one or two sentences :**  $2 \times 3 = 6$

(i) When and why did the expedition start off ? \_\_\_\_\_

(ii) Why did the mountaineers fail to reach the peak on Sunday morning ? \_\_\_\_\_

(iii) How has the State Government encouraged the Association? \_\_\_\_\_

### SECTION—B [Grammar & Vocabulary]

**4. Fill in the blanks with appropriate articles and prepositions:**

$1 \times 4 = 4$

\_\_\_\_\_ tigress captured in the Sundarbans \_\_\_\_\_ May 10 had to be brought to \_\_\_\_\_ Alipore Veterinary Hospital \_\_\_\_\_ treatment.

**5. Do as directed :**

$1 \times 4 = 4$

(a) 'Are cherry seeds lucky ?' asked Rakesh.

*(Change into indirect speech)*

Ans. \_\_\_\_\_

(b) Who does not love his parents ' ?

*(Change into an Assertive sentence)*

Ans. \_\_\_\_\_

(c) Please post the letter.

*(Change the Voice)*

Ans. \_\_\_\_\_

(d) As soon as he reached the station, the train left.

*(Rewrite using 'No sooner...than')*

Ans. \_\_\_\_\_



6. Choose the correct phrasal verbs from the list given below to replace the words underlined. Write the correct phrasal verbs in the boxes on the right-hand side, changing the forms, where necessary. There is one extra phrasal verb in the list:  $1 \times 4 = 4$

- (i) The soldiers surrendered at last.
- (ii) The son resembles his father.
- (iii) Two friends quarrelled for nothing.
- (iv) The strike was withdrawn.

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[ List of phrasal verbs:

take after, break out, fall out, give in, call off ]

7. Given below are the meanings of four words which you will find in the passage in Question No. 3. Find out the words and write them in the appropriate boxes on the right-hand side:  $2 \times 4 = 8$

- (i) pointed top of a mountain
- (ii) an organised journey with a particular purpose
- (iii) climb up
- (iv) the time or way something is planned to be done

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### SECTION—C

[Writing]

8. Write a paragraph (in about 100 words) about the person you like most in your family. Use the following points : 10

[The person's identity—occupation—special qualities—his/her influence on your life]

9. Write a letter (in about 80 words) to your friend about the benefits of reading a good newspaper everyday. Use the following points : 10

[A regular source of information—news and reports on current affairs—spread of knowledge—developing reading habits]

10. Suppose you organised a function in your school to honour the memory of Rabindranath Tagore on the occasion of his 150th birth anniversary. Write for your school magazine a report (in about 100 words) on the celebration, using the following points : 10

[Date, time and place—respected guests—the programme in brief—your views about the importance of this function]



### SECTION—D (SUPPLEMENTARY)

For the candidates who have NOT taken the Oral Examination  
(Including the External Candidates)

1. Make single words to replace the following expressions by using the prefixes listed below : 1×6 = 6

- |                     |   |  |
|---------------------|---|--|
| (i) not lawful      | = |  |
| (ii) not literate   | = |  |
| (iii) not mature    | = |  |
| (iv) not honest     | = |  |
| (v) not responsible | = |  |
| (vi) not correct    | = |  |

[ List of prefixes : —in ; —dis ; —un ; —im ; —ir ; —il ]

2. Choose the correct words from those within brackets to fill in the blanks in the following sentences : 1×4 = 4

- (i) I feel pain in my \_\_\_\_\_ (heel/heal).
- (ii) My friend always carries his \_\_\_\_\_ (dairy/diary) with him.
- (iii) Everybody should pay the \_\_\_\_\_ (fair/fare) to avoid fine.
- (iv) There are seven days in a \_\_\_\_\_ (week/weak).